

Bill Clinton: ‘No idea’ of Epstein’s criminality

Ex-president’s compelled testimony to Congress sets a new precedent

BY MAEGAN VAZQUEZ AND YASMEEN ABUTALEB

CHAPPAQUA, N.Y. — Former president Bill Clinton sought to distance himself from convicted sex offender Jeffrey Epstein during a lengthy closed-door deposition here Friday, saying he had no knowledge of Epstein’s crimes and stopped associating with him years before his first guilty plea.

“I had no idea of the crimes Epstein was committing. No matter how many photos you show me, I have two things that at the end of the day matter more than your interpretation of those 20-year-old photos,” Clinton said in his opening statement, which he shared on social media. “I saw nothing, and I did nothing wrong.”

He added: “But even with 20/20 hindsight, I saw nothing that ever gave me pause. We are only here because he hid it from everyone so well for so long.”

Clinton’s appearance before the House Oversight and Government Reform Committee was the first time a former president had been compelled to testify before Congress under a subpoena. It may set a precedent that could one day affect President Donald Trump, whose own ties to Epstein are also under scrutiny.

Trump has been uncharacteristically muted about Clinton’s appearance, saying that he did not

SEE CLINTON ON A4



REBECCA NOBLE/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

The Searching Mothers of Sonora, flanked by Mexico law enforcement, walk through a canyon Wednesday in Nogales, Mexico.

Moms’ group joins hunt for Nancy Guthrie

The women, who have located hundreds of drug and gang victims, say officials aren’t doing enough

BY ANNIE GOWEN IN NOGALES, MEXICO

Lidia Hernandez has been searching for her son, lost to drug violence in Mexico, for seven years. But she spent this week scouring rocky dirt for clues in the disappearance of a far more well-known crime victim — Nancy Guthrie.

On Sunday, Hernandez posted fliers on the mailbox at Guthrie’s home in the Catalina Foothills north of Tucson. On Wednesday,

she led a group of other “Searching Mothers” in prayer across the border in Mexico as they tried to find out whether Guthrie had been taken there. On Thursday, she returned to Guthrie’s neighborhood once again.

Hernandez said her group, the Searching Mothers of Sonora, feels authorities aren’t doing enough to find Guthrie, the 84-year-old mother of “Today” anchor Savannah Guthrie who was reported missing on Feb. 1.

It’s a common refrain for the mothers, who have used pickaxes and shovels to locate

hundreds of bodies of victims of drug and gang violence in Mexico themselves over the years, decrying government inaction all the while.

“They’re not looking for her!” Hernandez, 66, a retired food service worker from Nogales, Arizona, said. “So we have to step in.”

As the investigation entered its fourth week, unauthorized search parties have exacerbated the chaos surrounding the high-

SEE GUTHRIE ON A6

President orders government to stop using Anthropic’s AI tech

BY IAN DUNCAN, TARA COPP AND ELIZABETH DWOSKIN

The Trump administration placed AI firm Anthropic on a far-reaching national security blacklist Friday, directing federal agencies to stop using its technology and banning any other company that does business with the military from working with it, effective immediately.

President Donald Trump blast-

Pentagon declares the start-up a threat to national security

ed the artificial intelligence company as a risk to national security after a tumultuous week of negotiations between the start-up and the Pentagon.

“The Leftwing nut jobs at Anthropic have made a DISASTROUS MISTAKE trying to STRONG-ARM the Department of War, and force them to obey their Terms of Service instead of our Constitution,” Trump wrote in a post on his social media site Truth Social, using the administration’s preferred name for the Defense Department. “Their selfishness is putting AMERICAN LIVES at risk, our Troops in dan-

ger, and our National Security in JEOPARDY.”

Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth followed up late Friday, saying in a post on X that he was declaring Anthropic a supply-chain risk. “Effective immediately, no contractor, supplier, or partner that does business with the United States military may conduct any commercial activity with Anthropic,” Hegseth wrote.

Anthropic did not immediately

respond to a request for comment.

The company has resisted Pentagon demands that Anthropic allow the military to use its AI system, Claude, for any purpose permitted by the law. Anthropic had insisted on protections against its technology being used to power fully autonomous weapons or wide-scale domestic surveillance.

The dispute had reached an apparent impasse late Thursday

SEE PENTAGON ON A7

Trump: Regime change possible

HE’S ‘NOT THRILLED’ WITH IRAN TALKS

Signs of imminent war as mediator says deal near

BY KAREN DEYOUNG AND JOHN HUDSON

A U.S. military attack on Iran could result in regime change, President Donald Trump said Friday. “Nobody knows. ... It would be nice if we could do it without” military force, Trump said, “but sometimes you have to do it with.”

Trump, speaking with reporters before his morning departure from the White House for Texas and Florida, said he was “not thrilled” with how negotiations with Iran were going over his demand that it “not have nuclear weapons.”

Amid rising hints that war might be imminent, Omani Foreign Minister Badr Albusaidi, who mediated a Thursday negotiating session between the U.S. and Iran in Geneva, later said in an interview with CBS’s “Face the Nation” that substantial progress had been made on key U.S. demands and a deal on the broad parameters “actually can be reached tomorrow.”

Iran, he said, had agreed to “irreversibly” dilute its stockpile of near-weapons-grade uranium, highly enriched to 60 percent, to “a neutral level, a natural level.” CBS released a transcript of the interview, scheduled for Sunday broadcast, on Friday afternoon.

Albusaidi said agreement had also been reached on Iran’s “zero accumulation” of enriched material in the future and submission of all of its nuclear facilities to international inspection. A plan that Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi brought to Geneva on Thursday had proposed allowing uranium to be enriched to 1.5 percent to fuel a civil research reactor, according to people familiar with the proposal.

But Trump, around the time that the CBS transcript became public, said in Texas that he wanted “no enrichment. ... I’m

SEE IRAN ON A11

A dream of spring

A pedestrian in downtown Washington moves through warm sunlight Friday as meteorological winter nears its end. Today, highs may be as warm as the mid-60s, giving weary residents a respite from what has been a brutally cold season.



ROBERT MILLER/THE WASHINGTON POST

‘Our heroes are dying.’ Why Jackson’s death leaves a void.

There is no clear successor generation with the power to rally the Black community and people in the civil rights movement

BY GREGORY S. SCHNEIDER AND MICHELLE BOORSTEIN

In the early-morning hours after the Rev. Jesse Jackson died on Feb. 17, his family called another prominent pastor for prayer and solace. “A mighty lion has passed,” Bishop William Barber recalled the family saying.

“I’ve been thinking about that imagery,” said Barber, who leads Repairers of the Breach, an organization that aims to bring moral and religious language to causes such as safeguarding voting rights and alleviating poverty. “Because lions, they protect the pride, but they also expand the territory of the pride.” And Jackson expanded the notion of civil rights in America, he said: from the Black community to the full spectrum of people seeking justice.

Thousands were expected to pay respects Friday as Jackson’s remains lie in repose at Rainbow/PUSH headquarters in Chicago, following the decision by House Speaker Mike Johnson (R-Louisiana) to decline to allow Jackson to lie in honor at the U.S. Capitol.

Jackson’s death at age 84 comes at a perilous time for the civil rights crusade he helped lead for decades. Most of his iconic contemporaries are gone as President Donald Trump attacks their hard-fought principles, declaring war on diversity, equity and inclusion initiatives while the foundational achievement of the civil rights movement, the 1965 Voting Rights Act, may be on the verge of being overturned by the U.S. Supreme Court.

“Our heroes are dying, and the question has to be asked: Who comes next or what comes next?”

said author and political commentator Bakari Sellers. “This new era of regression, this new era of Trumpism, has shown clearly that ... our new leaders [are] not able to meet the moment.”

It’s a major test of the movement in a fragmented landscape of social media and political division with no clear successor generation to rally a response. The wellspring that produced leaders such as Jackson and the Rev. Martin Luther King Jr. — the Black church — no longer plays the same role. Institutional religion doesn’t have the authority or power it once did in the United States, experts said, and the religious right for decades has been more loudly — and successfully — merging its view of Christianity and politics.

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IN THE NEWS

A deal with Scouts The group will make several concessions, including getting rid of DEI, to retain its longtime relationship with the military, but girls are still allowed. A3

NASA setback A March takeoff for the first crewed lunar flyby in half a century was delayed as the rocket went in for repairs. A13

THE NATION **Surfers** in California rescued a family of six after their boat capsized in cold waters. A2 **New Yorkers** described squalid living conditions at the new mayor’s rental rip-off event. A3

THE WORLD **Pakistan** said it is in “open war” with Afghanistan as nations exchanged strikes. A10 **Lawyers** for Nicolás Maduro said the U.S. is blocking him from cash to fund his defense. A11

THE ECONOMY **The White House** handed a \$370 million windfall to one of the world’s largest exporters of natural gas by allowing the company to claim an “alternative fuels” tax incentive for operating some of the planet’s most heavily polluting ships. A12

STYLE **The Kennedy Center Honors** will continue, with a new name, amid the venue’s closure. B1

SPORTS **Jeff Galloway**, an Olympic distance runner whose “Jeffing” strategy of taking walking breaks inspired many, has died at 80. B7

THE REGION **Hundreds of** students around D.C. walked out of school and filled the city’s streets to protest ICE arrests. B11 **Meet Fancy**, 37 — the world’s oldest horse as declared by Guinness World Records — and her lifelong caretaker in Virginia. B11

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